

SafeGuard — Privacy Policy

Effective Date: May 2026 | Version 1.0

1. Introduction

SafeGuard is a personal safety Android application developed by Arisha Khan, students of BS Information Technology at the University of Layyah (Session 2023–2027). This Privacy Policy explains what data the app collects, how it is used, and how it is protected. By using SafeGuard, you agree to the terms described in this policy.

2. Information We Collect

SafeGuard may collect the following types of information:

- a) Personal Information:** Name, phone number, email address, home address, medical information, and profession — provided voluntarily by the user during registration or profile setup.
- b) Location Data:** Real-time GPS location is accessed only when the user activates the SOS Alert or Location Sharing feature. Location data is shared directly with the user's trusted contacts via SMS and is not stored on any server.
- c) Audio Data:** The Audio Recording feature records audio and saves it locally on the user's device only. Audio files are never uploaded to any server.
- d) Trusted Contacts:** Names and phone numbers of trusted contacts are stored in Firebase Realtime Database linked to the user's account.

3. How We Use Your Information

The information collected is used solely for the following purposes:

- To send SOS alerts with GPS location to trusted contacts during emergencies.
- To display the user's profile and allow them to update personal and medical details.
- To authenticate the user securely via Firebase Authentication.
- To provide AI-powered safety guidance through the in-app assistant.
- To log ride details (driver name, vehicle number, destination) for user safety.

4. Data Storage and Security

User account data is stored securely in Google Firebase, which uses industry-standard encryption. Audio recordings are stored only on the user's local device and are never transmitted or uploaded. We do not sell, rent, or share personal data with any third party for commercial purposes.

5. Third-Party Services

SafeGuard uses the following third-party services that may collect data according to their own privacy policies:

- **Google Firebase** (Authentication, Realtime Database, FCM) — <https://firebase.google.com/support/privacy>

- **Google Maps API** — <https://policies.google.com/privacy>

6. Permissions Required

SafeGuard requests the following Android permissions:

- ACCESS_FINE_LOCATION / ACCESS_COARSE_LOCATION — For GPS-based SOS alerts
- RECORD_AUDIO — For discreet background audio recording
- SEND_SMS — For sending SOS alerts to trusted contacts
- CALL_PHONE — For directly dialing emergency services
- INTERNET — For Firebase database and AI assistant connectivity
- RECEIVE_BOOT_COMPLETED — For background service restart after device reboot

7. Children's Privacy

SafeGuard is intended for users aged 16 and above. We do not knowingly collect personal information from children under 16. If you believe a child has provided us with personal information, please contact us.

8. User Rights

Users have the right to access, update, or delete their personal information at any time through the app's Profile section. Users may also request complete data deletion by contacting the developers.

9. Changes to This Policy

This Privacy Policy may be updated from time to time. Any changes will be reflected in the app and on the repository. Continued use of the app after changes means acceptance of the updated policy.

10. Contact

If you have any questions about this Privacy Policy, you may contact the developers:

Arisha Khan — University of Layyah, BS IT (2023–2027)

GitHub: <https://github.com/Arisha38>